



RCCG OCEANIA

Holy Spirit & Power

AUTHORITY OF THE BELIEVER IN CHRIST

AT A GLANCE

BIG IDEA

Discover the profound truth of your spiritual authority as a believer seated with Christ. Learn how to exercise this authority over the devil and navigate spiritual warfare with confidence. Embrace your role in God's kingdom and reign in life through Jesus Christ.

PRIMARY PASSAGES

Ephesians 1:16-23

Ephesians 2:1-6

Luke 10:19

Ephesians 6:12

James 4:7

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Believers are seated with Christ in heavenly places, sharing in His authority.
- Spiritual authority is exercised through understanding and using the name of Jesus.
- Resisting the devil is an active and necessary part of spiritual warfare.
- Praying for God to rebuke the devil is ineffective; believers must exercise their own authority.
- Every believer has the same authority that Paul had in Christ.

INTRODUCTION

The authority of the believer in Christ is a profound truth that transforms how we engage with the spiritual realm. As believers, we are not powerless; we are seated with Christ, sharing in His authority. This study explores how to understand and exercise this authority effectively.

SCRIPTURE READING

- **Ephesians 1:16-23** — Paul prays for the church to receive wisdom and revelation about their authority.
- **Ephesians 2:1-6** — Describes believers being raised and seated with Christ, emphasizing their authority.
- **Ephesians 3:14-19** — Paul prays for believers to be strengthened and to know the love of Christ, which is foundational for exercising authority.
- **Luke 10:19** — Jesus gives authority to tread on serpents and scorpions, symbolizing spiritual power.
- **Ephesians 6:12** — Highlights the nature of spiritual warfare against principalities and powers.
- **James 4:7** — Instructs believers to resist the devil, affirming their active role in spiritual battles.
- **1 Peter 5:8-9** — Encourages believers to be vigilant and resist the devil, knowing they are not alone in their struggles.
- **Colossians 1:13** — Affirms that believers have been delivered from the power of darkness and translated into the kingdom of Christ.

KEY POINTS

1. **RECOGNIZE YOUR POSITION IN CHRIST** — Understanding your spiritual position is foundational to exercising authority. Believers are seated with Christ, sharing in His power and authority. This position is not earned but given through grace, allowing believers to operate from a place of victory.

- Reflect on your identity in Christ and what it means to be seated with Him.
- Meditate on Ephesians 2:1-6 and visualize your position in the heavenly realms.
- Thank God for the authority given to you through Christ.

Scripture: Ephesians 2:1-6

2. **UNDERSTAND YOUR AUTHORITY OVER THE DEVIL** — Believers have been given authority over the devil and his schemes. This authority is exercised through faith and the name of Jesus. Recognizing this power enables believers to confront spiritual opposition with confidence.

- Identify areas in your life where you need to exercise authority.
- Speak the name of Jesus over situations that challenge your faith.
- Pray for increased faith to believe in the authority you possess.

Scripture: Luke 10:19 Ephesians 1:16-23

3. **RESIST THE DEVIL STEADFAST IN FAITH** — Active resistance against the devil is crucial. Believers must stand firm in their faith and use their authority to overcome spiritual challenges. This involves being vigilant and discerning in spiritual matters.

- Practice resisting temptations by declaring your authority in Christ.
- Encourage fellow believers to stand firm in their faith.
- Study James 4:7 and 1 Peter 5:8-9 to understand the importance of resistance.

Scripture: James 4:7 1 Peter 5:8-9

KEY POINTS (CONT.)

4. **EXERCISE AUTHORITY IN JESUS' NAME** — The name of Jesus is powerful and effective in spiritual warfare. Believers are encouraged to declare their authority over circumstances using His name. This practice is a demonstration of faith and reliance on Jesus' power.

- Use the name of Jesus in prayer to address spiritual challenges.
- Share testimonies of victory achieved through the name of Jesus.
- Commit to learning more about the power of Jesus' name in Scripture.

Scripture: Ephesians 6:12 Colossians 1:13

GROUP DISCUSSION

Tip: Use these questions to guide the group from seeing → understanding → applying.

OBSERVATION

- What does it mean to be seated with Christ according to Ephesians 2:1-6?
- How does Luke 10:19 describe the authority given to believers?
- What are the principalities and powers mentioned in Ephesians 6:12?

INTERPRETATION

- Why is it important for believers to understand their authority in Christ?
- How does the authority of the believer impact spiritual warfare?
- What role does faith play in exercising authority over the devil?

APPLICATION

- In what areas of your life do you need to exercise more authority?
- How can you actively resist the devil in your daily life?
- What steps can you take to deepen your understanding of your position in Christ?

PRAYER FOCUS

- Pray for wisdom and revelation to understand your spiritual authority in Christ.
- Ask for strength and courage to exercise authority over spiritual challenges.
- Seek God's guidance to remain steadfast in faith and resist the devil.
- Thank God for the victory and authority given through Jesus Christ.

NEXT STEP

Reflect on your spiritual position in Christ and begin to exercise your authority in daily life challenges.

CONCLUSION

Understanding and exercising the authority of the believer in Christ is essential for living a victorious Christian life. By recognizing our position in Christ, understanding our authority over the devil, and actively resisting spiritual opposition, we can navigate life's challenges with confidence and power.